



Contacting HARMONY

Synchronising Outlook contacts helps you lay your hands on just the right one when you mean business!

You know the predicament—you have a laptop, an office desktop, and a handheld, and then you have hundreds of contacts scattered across these three gadgets. Which basically means, each time you need to find the details of one of those contacts, you have to remember where you saved them. Which in turn means—oh well, forget it!

You'd rather spend that time synchronising all your contacts. Why? Because, sree, synchronising makes managing your Microsoft Outlook contacts as easy as the proverbial apple pie. Here's how.

Synchronising on two computers

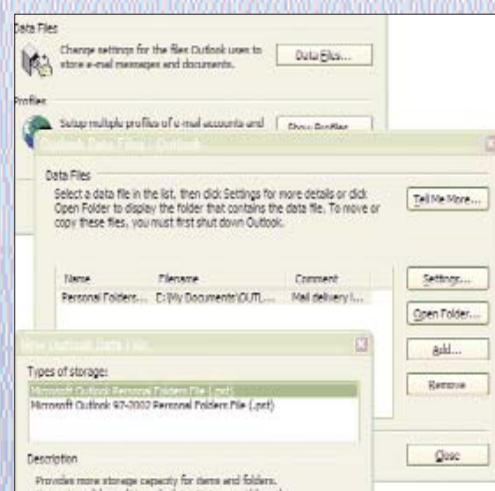
You start off by manually updating the contacts on a system that runs Outlook from another PC by copying the Personal

Folder Storage (.pst) file onto it. A .pst file is huge—it contains all your mails, contacts, calendar, tasks and notes—so the transfer process could be tedious, unless both systems are on the same network. One way to overcome this is to export only the contacts folder as a .pst file. An even better solution is to create a separate .pst file for contacts, as it makes for easier contacts management.

For example, the size of this writer's .pst file was 129 MB. By creating a separate file for contacts, it reduced to less than 1 MB. Get the picture?

Creating a new .pst file

To add a new .pst file that stores the transferred contacts, go to **Control Panel > Mail** and click Data Files. Click Add, choose 'Outlook Personal Folder File' and click OK. If you use Outlook 2003, keep in mind that the .pst file can't be used by earlier versions. So, make sure you choose 'Outlook 97-2002 Personal



Create a new data file to store contacts

Folder File'. Now, specify a filename and location for the file and click OK. Then, in the screen that appears, enter a suitable name such as 'Shared Contacts' for the folder and click OK.

